Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/ernesto-cortez (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Strategic Leadership
Growth Strategies
Aerospace Industries

Certifications

Generative AI Overview for Project Managers
Airline Transport Pilot (ATP)
CompTIA Security+
Aircraft Flight Instructor (CFI/CFII/MEI)

Ernesto Cortez

VP of Business DevelopmentAEVEX Aerospace Global ServicesDriving solutions for Proposals up to $3.3BISR, C5ISR, Counter-UAS & Missionized Aircraft SolutionsManaged $160M annual budget
Augusta, Georgia, United States

Summary

As a hands-on leader and Visionary Executive, I've led teams from 10 - 3,200 people through major transitions. A disciplined and goal-oriented Chief of Staff, I've managed a $160M budget driving operations and training for 16K employees. I'm known for establishing a climate of accountability and trust around a unifying vision. I enable decentralized initiative allowing high performers to thrive!

I SPECIALIZE IN ➢
➡# LEADERSHIP: I've led diverse teams ranging from 10 to 3,200 people in stable environments or crisis
➡# ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT: I've driven alignment of strategy, structure, people for 18+ years in large orgs
➡# TEAM BUILDING: I've succeeded in removing barriers and building cohesion across Industry, DoD and I.C. teams
➡# STRATEGIC PLANNING: Created 3-5 year strategies for pipeline and growth with clear and achievable goals
➡# EXECUTION: Expert at hands-on crisis management and navigating high risk environments.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS ➢
Served as the Technical Lead on a $3.3 Billion GSA FEDSIM proposal response.
Led 3,200 employees distributed across11 time zones and operating over 80 manned/unmanned aircraft
Managed a budget of $150M+ while instituting process to replace least efficient 10% with higher-ROI investments
Executed the move of an 1,800 person organization from Virginia to Georgia with no disruption in client delivery

CONTACT ME ➢ Ernesto.allen.cortez@gmail.com

MORE ABOUT ME ➢
I believe trust is fundamental to underpin all high-performing teams. Throughout my career I have been exposed to fantastic leaders who taught me that a well-trained leader operating at the speed of trust, could solve your toughest problems. I strive everyday to be a servant leader actively building and supporting a climate of respect.

EDUCATION
B.S., Computer Science, US Military Academy, West Point
MBA, Trident University
M.S., National Security Strategy, National Defense University

FUN FACTS ➢
I love fitness with family and friends. I've completed an Ironman and Pike's Peak Marathon.
I speak Spanish and have been to 45 countries and 46 states
I have owned two airplanes and I'm a current single/multi-engine/ instrument flight instructor

Experience

AEVEX Aerospace
Vice President of Business Development
September 2025 - Present (9 months)
Augusta GA

As VP of Business Development & Growth at AEVEX Aerospace, I drive strategy, partnerships, and mission delivery across the company's portfolio of special mission aircraft solutions, unmanned systems, and autonomous technologies. My role focuses on aligning AEVEX's advanced capabilities with U.S. and allied defense requirements to deliver rapidly fieldable, operationally relevant solutions.

I oversee growth initiatives across:

Unmanned & Autonomous Platforms – including the Atlas Group 1 UAS, Disruptor loitering munition, Mako Group 3 UAS, and Mako Light—systems

engineered for ISR, autonomy, and precision strike missions in contested environments.

Aircraft Services – providing turnkey ISR operations, aircraft overhaul and sustainment, and full-spectrum modification and integration for manned and unmanned special mission platforms.

Rapid Prototyping & Integration – ensuring warfighters receive next-generation autonomy, payload integration, and standoff ISR solutions at speed and scale.

By bridging cutting-edge technology with operational relevance, I work to ensure AEVEX delivers on its mission: empowering the warfighter with capabilities that ensure they are never in a fair fight.

Triad Advantage, LLC

Founder and Chief Executive

August 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)

Augusta, Georgia, United States

Drawing on decades of real-world experience in aviation, intelligence, and special operations, Ernesto Cortez formed Triad Advantage to focus on the convergence of aviation, intelligence, and special operations (SOF). This role is rooted in decades of operational experience and a desire to give back to the national security community through insight, mentorship, and systems-level thinking.

Serve as a thought partner to national security leaders navigating emerging threats and asymmetric challenges.

Cultivate collaboration between government, industry, and military professionals to drive innovation at the edge of national defense.

Triad Advantage exists to foster synergies where aviation, intelligence, and SOF intersect—ensuring that strategic thinking keeps pace with operational realities.

Booz Allen Hamilton

Technologist/Business Development ◆ Tech Lead on $3.3B Proposal ◆ Task Lead on $850M Proposal

June 2023 - September 2025 (2 years 4 months)

Augusta, Georgia, United States

As a strategic leader I generate opportunities for a Fortune 500 company and deliver technical Solutions to enhance the capababilities of clients in the Defense space

• Overall Techincal Lead and Task Lead on a $3.3 Billion GSA FEDSIM Proposal
• Key Personnel and Task Lead on $850 Million GSA FEDSIM Proposal
• Lead on-site coordinator for AFCEA TechNet Augusta Expo

Support $80 Million in Pipeline, helping diversify value stream to minimize risk and protect employees

Metrea

VP - Cyber Engagement ◆ Supported M&A w/100% portfolio expansion ◆ Strategic aerospace advisor

August 2022 - May 2023 (10 months)

Augusta, GA

Vice President leading efforts to expand cyber, signals intelligence, electronic warfare and aviation operations, training and support opportunities to US Dept of Defense, foreign partners and allies and civil institutions

◆ Led foundational groundwork in pursuit of GSA FEDSIM Prime award in Large Business category
◆ Trusted partner and subject-matter-expert on aerospace matters in the defense and civil space
◆ Developed integrated Cyber, EW solutions for air platforms across a spectrum of strategic use cases

Expanded B2B partnership options and deepened connections with trusted Defense partners and officials

Touchstone Futures

Principal ◆ Strategic Advisor ◆ Intelligence and Aviation Subject Matter Expert

August 2022 - May 2023 (10 months)

Augusta, Georgia, United States

• Collaborated with national leaders in cyber and intelligence fields to identify growth opportunities
• Utilized deep connections within the federal space to shape strategic initiatives

• Operated in a small team of experts with decades of executive-level experience in cyber, intel, and strategy

U.S. Army Cyber Command

Chief of Staff ◆ Managed $150M budget ◆ Led staff of 800+ synchronizing 16K employees

August 2020 - August 2022 (2 years 1 month)

Fort Gordon, GA

Executive Leader/Chief of Staff for 16K employees in a globally employed organization responsible for planning and executing Cyberspace operations and network defense. Resourced, organized and structured daily operations ensuring seamless collaboration across echelons.

• Managed a $150M annual budget.
• Led, organized, and synchronized daily operations of an 800 person staff
• Synchronized the Directors of Finance, HR, Security, Information Technology, and Logistics

U.S. Army Intelligence and Security Command (INSCOM)

116th MI Brigade Commander ◆ Led 3,200 globally disbursed employees ◆ Operated 80+ aircraft

August 2018 - August 2020 (2 years 1 month)

Fort Gordon, Georgia

Commanding officer and Operations Lead of the U.S. Army's only Aerial Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR) Brigade. Led, trained and employed five geographically separated Battalions and the Joint Surveillance Target Acquisition Radar System (JSTARS) Detachment

• Operated over 80 manned and unmanned aircraft valued in excess of $2.1 Billion
• Managed a $46 Million budget
• Commanded over 3,200 Soldiers, Civilians and Contractors distributed across 11 time zones
• Executed a prototype for the Army’s first utilization of remote split operations for unmanned aircraft to be flown in combat areas while operated from bases in the U.S.
• Led and executed Army’s operational test of AI-enabled Project Maven leveraging ML + data fusion

Central Intelligence Agency

CENTCOM Liaison to CIA ◆ Senior Operations Officer ◆ Executive Advisor
June 2016 - July 2018 (2 years 2 months)
Virginia, United States

• Sole liaison between an intel agency and US Central Command executing 2 land wars

• Directly briefed senior officials including Director (Cabinet Member) and Deputy Director

U.S. Army Intelligence and Security Command (INSCOM)
3 years

Director, Aerial Intelligence & Sensors ◆ Synchronized $2.1 Billion Portfolio ◆ Led staff of 24
August 2014 - July 2015 (1 year)
Ft Belvoir, VA

Battalion Commander ◆ Visionary Executive ◆ Led 500+ employees
August 2012 - August 2014 (2 years 1 month)
1st MI Bn, Wiesbaden, Germany

160th Special Operations Aviation Regiment (Airborne)
4 years 2 months

Chief, Special Mgmt Division ◆ Human Resources Executive ◆ Career Manager for 3,000+
July 2010 - July 2012 (2 years 1 month)
Ft Knox, KY - Human Resources Command (HRC)

Human Resources executive providing tailored career and assignment management for 3,000+ Special Operations employees

Battalion Operations Officer / Executive Officer
June 2008 - June 2010 (2 years 1 month)
4-160th SOAR, Ft Lewis, WA

US Army
Army Aviation Officer
June 1995 - June 2008 (13 years 1 month)
United States

Education

United States Military Academy at West Point

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science · (June 1991 - June 1995)

National Defense University

Master of Science - MS, National Security Strategy · (July 2015 - June 2016)

Trident University International

M.B.A., Business Administration and Management, General · (2011)